

next



FLAT STICK ends the week on the Queensland border. Will he get stranded due to DIESEL shortages join me next week to find out.

P.S. I found my headphones working but run over likely by me

Flat stick 3



/50

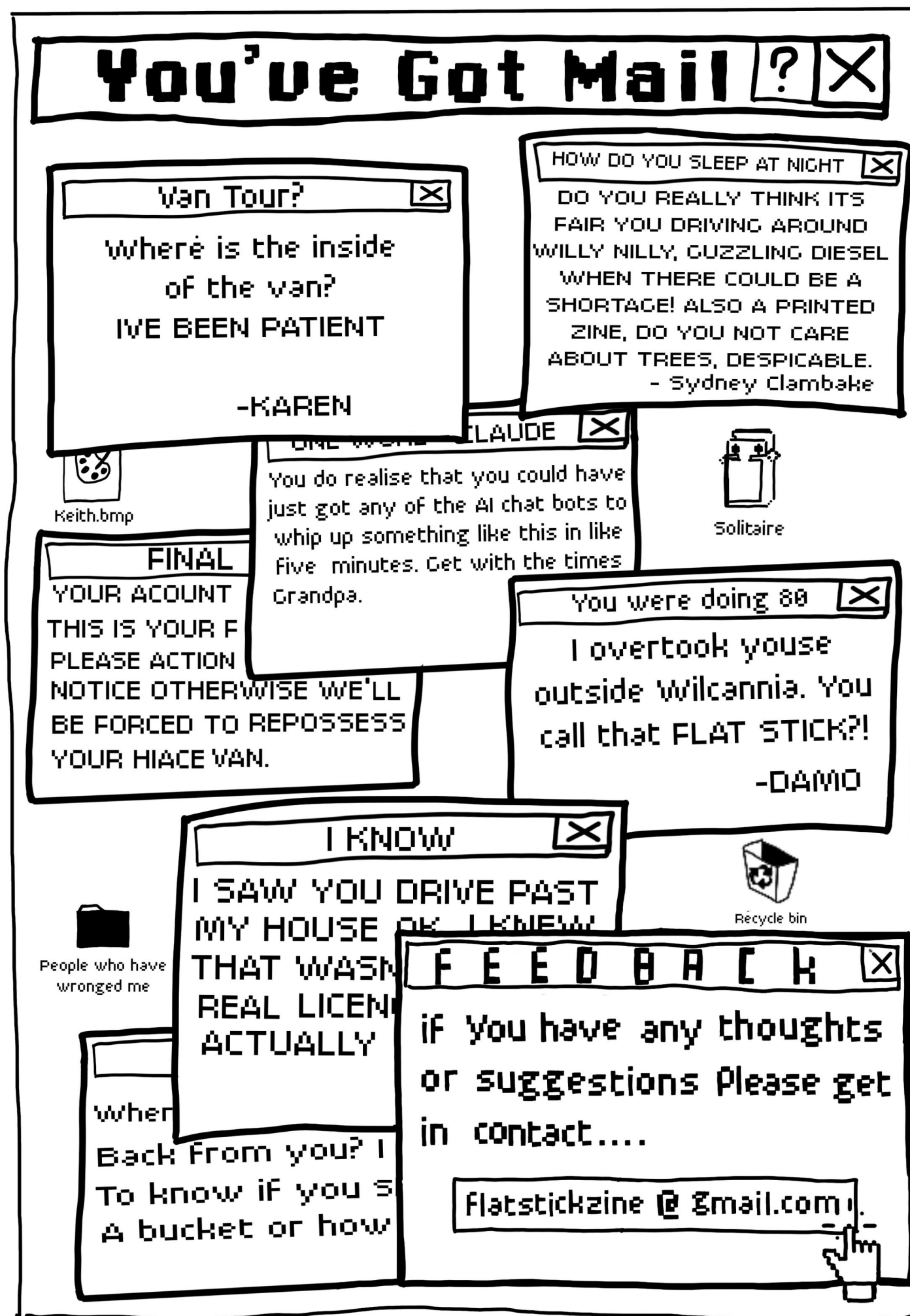
PRINTED AT

LATE
MARCH 2026

Diesel \$1.8 /L

FLAT STICK is a zine documenting my trip around Australia. All photos are mine, taken on 35mm film & developed in the van. zines are printed in the great public libraries of Australia

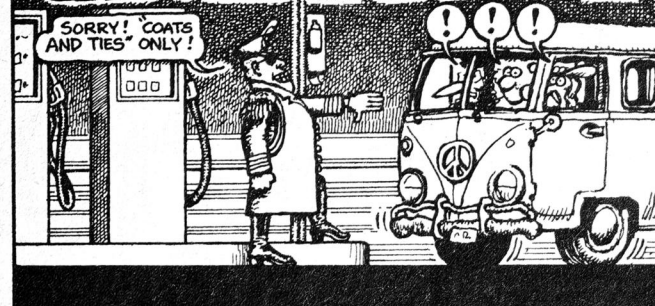
To follow along with the journey & see other zines please visit:
FLATSTICKZINE.GITHUB.IO



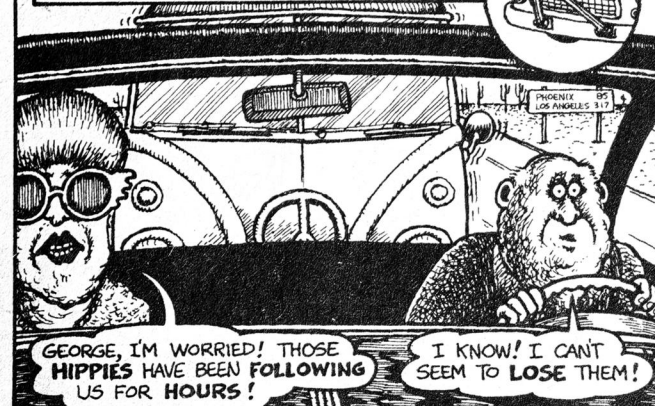
the adventures of those **FABULOUS FURRY FREAK BROTHERS** by Gilbert Shelton

AND NOW, WE BRING YOU ANOTHER IN OUR CONTINUING SERIES OF HELPFUL HINTS ON HOW TO SURVIVE IN OUR DETERIORATING URBAN ENVIRONMENT. THIS WEEK...

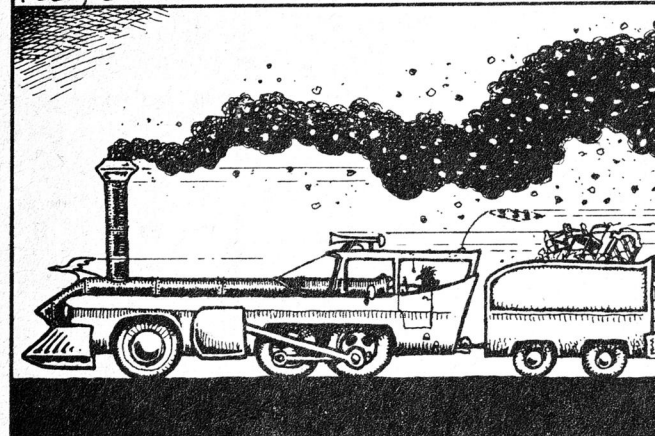
HOW TO COPE WITH THE GASOLINE FAMINE



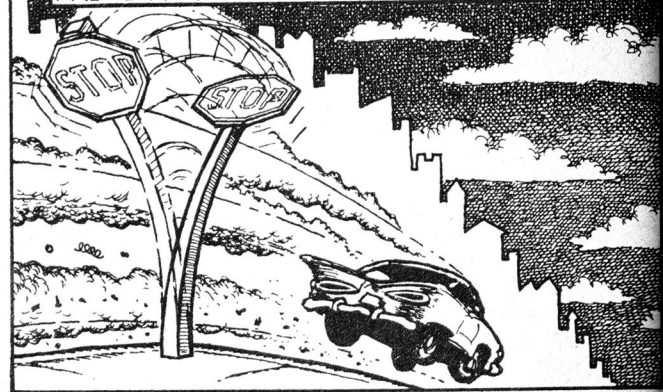
CONSTRUCT THIS USEFUL SWINGING HOOK ON THE FRONT OF YOUR CAR SO THAT YOU CAN ATTACH YOURSELF TO THE CAR AHEAD.



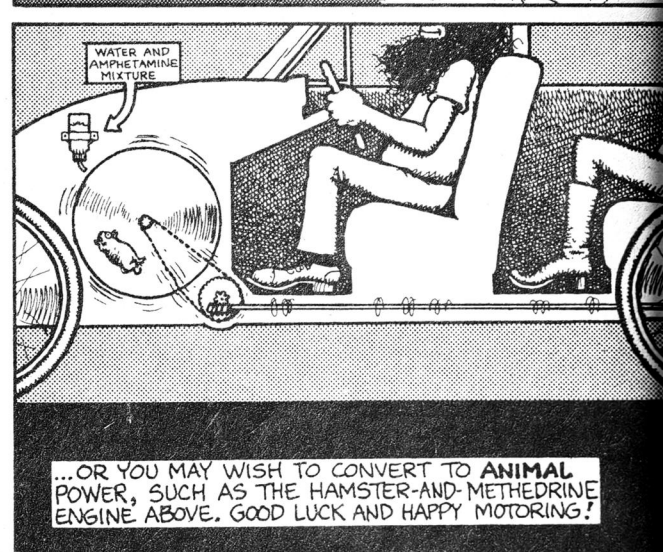
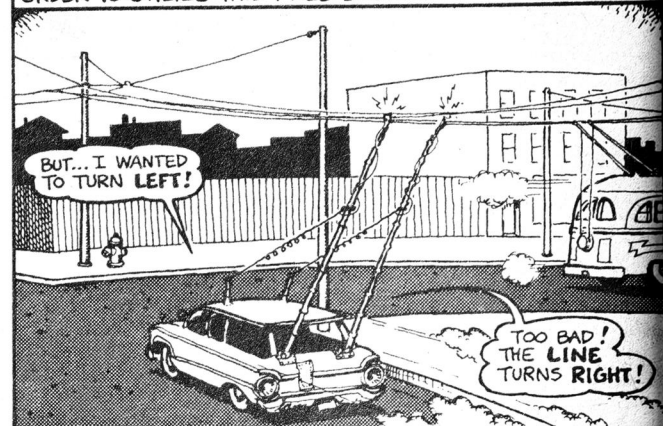
IN THE NEAR FUTURE, SMALL STEAM ENGINES WILL BE AVAILABLE FOR AUTOMOBILES WHICH WILL USE ANY OF A NUMBER OF THINGS CHEAPER THAN GASOLINE FOR FUEL, SUCH AS DOLLAR BILLS OR CHIVAS REGAL.



FIRST, ALWAYS ENDEAVOR TO MAKE THE BEST USE OF WHATEVER GASOLINE IS AVAILABLE. AVOID SUCH FUEL-WASTING HABITS AS STOPPING FOR STOP SIGNS.



IF YOUR CITY HAS TROLLEYS OR ELECTRIC BUSES, YOU COULD INSTALL AN ELECTRIC MOTOR IN YOUR AUTO IN ORDER TO UTILIZE THIS FREE SOURCE OF POWER.



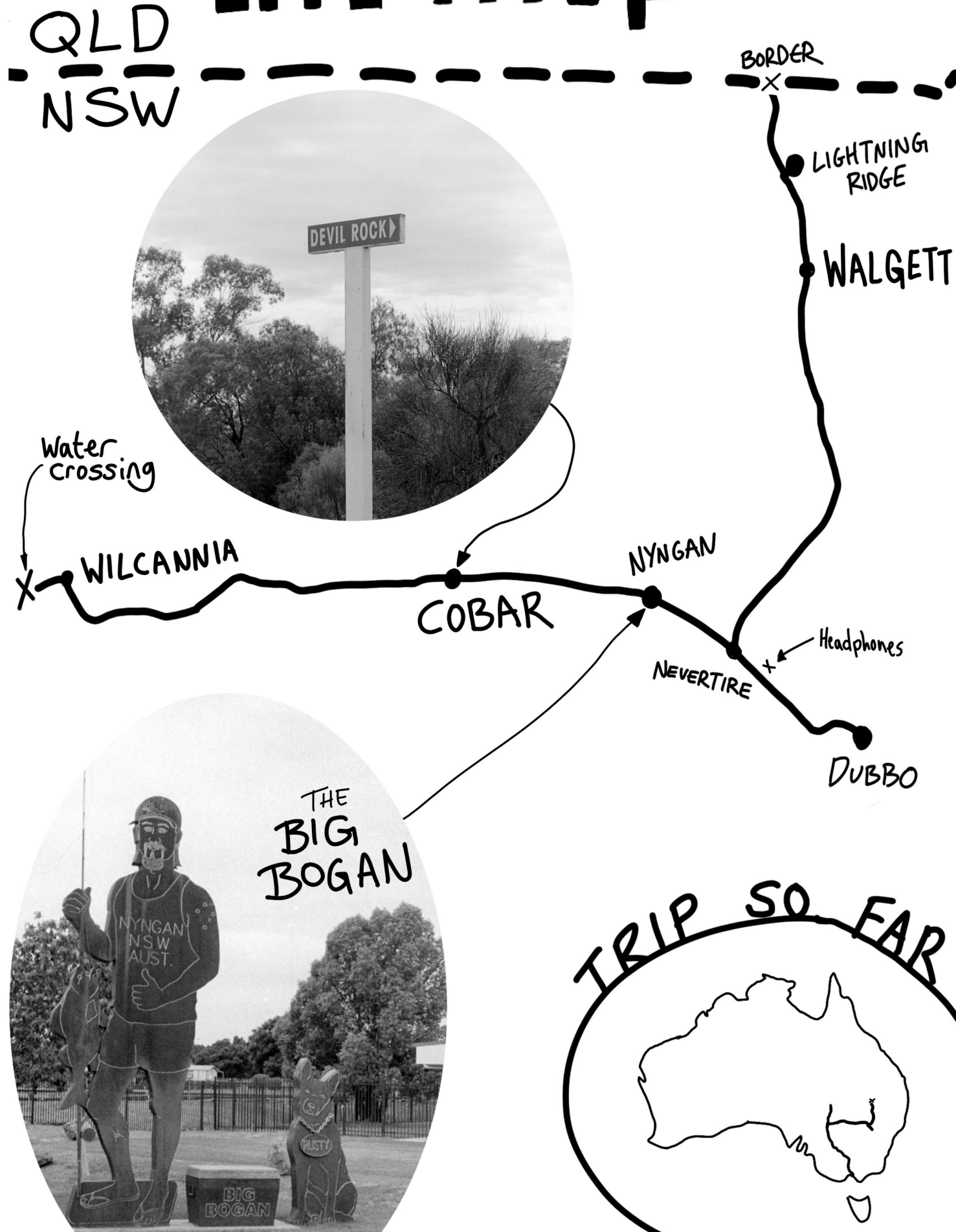
We interrupt our usual program for a comic from 1973 which feels very topical right now.

Welcome,

After a while stuck I hit the road varing to go, racking up the Ks & diesel costs! Eager to get up to the gold mining country but making a few stops along the way.

love Jared x+

the map



One such character is Amigo, an Italian who arrived in LR in 1973 aged 25. After years on his lease & no lucky strikes he began to build a castle, using the ironstone boulders he had dug out, all whilst being totally illegal. Disputes with the council ended with Amigo threatening to knock it down. It was Heritage Listed to preserve its history & is now a tourist attraction. The story takes a darker turn when Amigo was charged & sentenced for murder in 2020 at the castle. Shooting Christine Neilan point blank after she asked for money & then covering it up for 18 months. He is serving 13 years but the castle remains open for tourists (not me)

lightning ridge

The haphazard, individual style of places like Lightning Ridge always fascinate me, there is something so pure in it. You lease a lot for the year, bring in your caravan & get fossicking. You can imagine the larrikins & cowboys it attracts. The town has tonnes of character, rusted out machinery & a laid back feel.



scan to see the dashcam footage of the EMUs crossing the road!

crossing

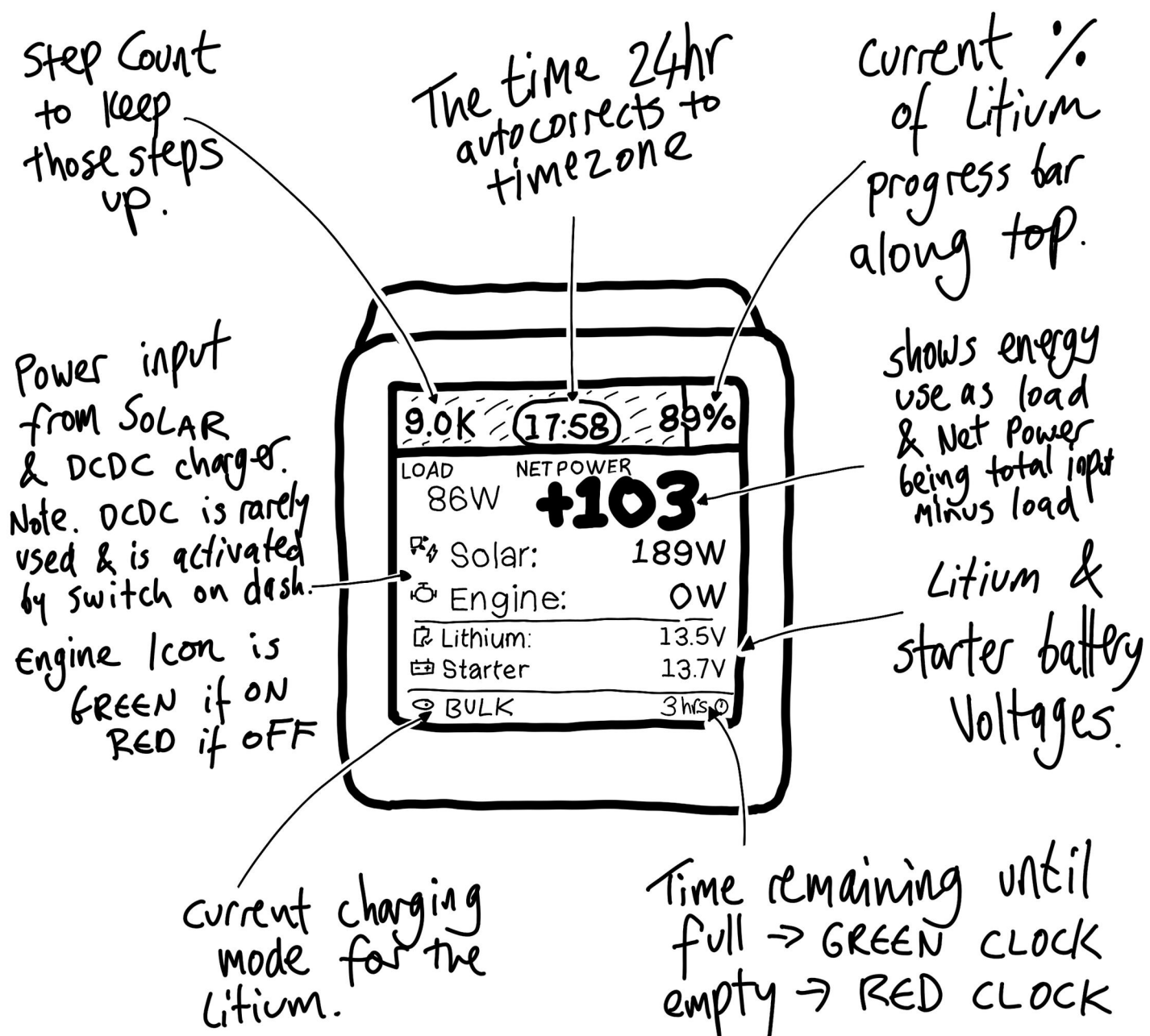


It had been 3 days of watching ROAD TRAINS & 4WDS slowly cross the flooded BARRIER HWY. The water slowly receding, I had a feeling today was the day as I walked down to inspect the depth. The council worker confirmed my feeling, it's now as a big pot hole is forming. I brought the van up & we watched as a worker dumped rubble into the ever growing pot hole beneath the surface. I got the nod & slowly eased in to the water, the wake rising around me, I continued on & it was strange sight water all around me, except a submerged HILUX. As I made my way through the nerves melted away & exhilaration took its place.



Sienna...

you may have seen it on the front cover
the little box on the dash. I reprogrammed
it to give me some key figures whilst driving.
Here's a breakdown...





Goats



The roads in western NSW have been filled with goats grazing. they are an introduced species from the early days of Australia, even some on the first fleet. Seen as a pest, fighting against sheep & other livestock for water & feed. Its estimated over 5 million feral goats are in Western NSW. In recent times however they have become a \$235 million export trade with Australia becoming the worlds largest exporter of goat meat. The goats needing little to no help from farmers to survive they became a life line during drought & hard times. I took the pic above in a road stop that for some reason had many clocks nailed into trees.



cobar

I flew along with my new found freedom & made it to COBAR, The Copper City. I spied a public library & reversed in. Issue #2 was ready for printing & as I did the Librarian told me a story about how she once got caught in flood waters. Coming back from a bartending shift she attempted a crossing & got stuck, she had 3% phone battery, called her bf who had a go at her, the police told her to piss off & it was only the SES who showed up & human chained across that saved her. I asked her what's it like in COBAR, she said she enjoys running the art classes & showed me a painting of a cow she had done. She told me she used to do kids face painting but COBAR doesn't have many kids & old people don't really want their faces painted as much. I left looking for a camp for the night & in my search found a sign to DEVIL ROCK (MAP PAGE) intrigued I followed the many signs until I made it. It came me the creeps so I left & camped near the pic above.



snip-snip

It's too hot for long hair & I thought I'd give it a go myself, a little snip here, a little snip there, I'm surprised it actually turned out somewhat presentable. I'll keep going I think. Afterwards I took a dip in the Artesian Bore Baths at Lightning Ridge. Two million year old water heated in the earth core & pumped out at $\sim 41^{\circ}\text{C}$ people believe it has healing powers, hopefully on hairstyles.





I kept driving like a madman & made it to dubbo before I could explore I realised I had lost my headphones & I better had back to a few spots they could possibly be. I was already there so I thought I'll deposit my bottles & cans. As I got out I heard this hissing sound & watched as the tire on the car next to me, slowly deflate. I stepped in & gave a hand, good practice in case it happens to me. The owner was named SAGAR & was in town for a hospital appointment for his baby. He thanked me & insisted he buy me a cold drink & take a selfie →
MY GOOD DEED DONE FOR TODAY.



